

UAE Cash Buyer's Guide — Three Emirates, H1 2026

Three emirates · Tax comparison · Financing guide · Updated July 2026

AED 419.9B

H1 2026 TOTAL TRANSACTIONS

112,850

TOTAL DEALS

~80%

CASH SHARE OF DEAL VALUE

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Dubai posted its second-best half-year ever in H1 2026 — and the healthiest signal is behavioral: ready homes outsold off-plan by value (AED 146.7B vs 139.8B) for the first time in years. Cash dominates: mortgages were only about a fifth of deal value (AED 102B of 419.9B). Cash buyers set the price in this market — and in high-supply corridors, they now negotiate from strength.

H1 2026 KEY METRICS

Metric	Value	Source
Total transactions	AED 419.9B / 112,850	DLD H1 2026
Sales value	AED 286.4B / ~86,000 deals	DLD H1 2026
Ready vs off-plan	146.7B vs 139.8B	DLD H1 2026
Off-plan office sales	AED 13.1B (record)	DLD H1 2026
Avg gross yield	6.58% (apts 6.9%)	Cavendish Maxwell, Jul 2026
Corridor range	AED 1,300–4,240/sqft	DLD/E&V Jan–Jun 2026

WHERE CASH IS DEPLOYING — AND WHERE IT ISN'T

Demand is softening hardest where supply is heaviest: Dubai South (-50% search demand YoY), Business Bay (-27%), JVC (-26%). Established, supply-constrained communities — Dubai Hills, Palm Jumeirah, Creek Harbour — are holding value. Cash wins in 2026 by buying scarcity, not brochures.

RESIDENCY & STRUCTURE

10-year Golden Visa requires property worth AED 2M+ (since Feb 2026, off-plan qualifies on the registered Oqood price — no minimum paid equity; mortgaged properties qualify with a bank NOC). Properties from AED 750K qualify for a 2-year renewable residence visa (Taskeen).

THE BOTTOM LINE

Zero tax, a USD-pegged currency, and a market that rewards buyers who do due diligence. H1 2026 favors cash buyers who target ready assets in supply-constrained corridors — and negotiate hard everywhere else.

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